

Gut Health Recovery Workbook

Food Sensitivity Tracker & Healing Protocol

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A Comprehensive Health & Wellness Workbook

Medical Disclaimer

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Introduction

Your gut is often called your 'second brain' - and for good reason. The gut microbiome influences everything from digestion and immunity to mental health and energy levels. If you're experiencing bloating, irregular bowel movements, food sensitivities, or unexplained fatigue, your gut health may need attention.

This workbook provides a structured approach to identifying food triggers, healing your gut lining, and rebuilding a healthy microbiome through diet and lifestyle changes.

Who This Book Is For

- People with IBS, bloating, or chronic digestive issues
- Those suspecting food sensitivities or intolerances
- Anyone recovering from antibiotic use or gut infections
- People with autoimmune conditions linked to gut health
- Anyone wanting to optimize their microbiome

Chapter 1: Understanding Your Gut Microbiome

The Gut Ecosystem

Your gut contains trillions of microorganisms - bacteria, fungi, viruses, and other microbes that form a complex ecosystem. This microbiome weighs about 3-5 pounds and contains more genetic material than your own cells.

Functions of a Healthy Gut

- Digests food and absorbs nutrients
- Produces vitamins (B12, K, folate)
- Regulates immune system (70% lives in gut)
- Produces neurotransmitters (95% of serotonin)
- Protects against pathogens
- Regulates inflammation throughout the body
- Influences weight and metabolism

Signs of an Unhealthy Gut

Digestive Symptoms

- Bloating after meals
- Gas and abdominal discomfort
- Constipation, diarrhea, or alternating
- Acid reflux or heartburn
- Undigested food in stool

Non-Digestive Symptoms

- Chronic fatigue
- Brain fog and poor concentration
- Skin problems (acne, eczema, rosacea)
- Mood disorders (anxiety, depression)
- Frequent colds and infections
- Joint pain and inflammation
- Sugar cravings

What Damages Gut Health

- Antibiotics (kill beneficial bacteria along with harmful)
- NSAIDs and acid-blocking medications
- High-sugar, low-fiber diet
- Chronic stress
- Alcohol and processed foods
- Food additives and emulsifiers
- Environmental toxins

The 5R Protocol for Gut Healing

This evidence-based framework guides gut recovery:

- 1. REMOVE: Eliminate triggers (foods, stress, toxins, infections)
- 2. REPLACE: Add digestive support (enzymes, acid, bile)
- 3. REINOCULATE: Restore beneficial bacteria (probiotics, prebiotics)
- 4. REPAIR: Heal the gut lining (L-glutamine, bone broth, zinc)
- 5. REBALANCE: Lifestyle factors (sleep, stress, movement)

Chapter 2: Gut Health Self-Assessment

Symptom Severity Assessment

Rate each symptom 0 (none) to 5 (severe). Complete at baseline and every 4 weeks.

Date: __/__/__

Bloating: ____/5 Notes: _____
Gas/flatulence: ____/5 Notes: _____
Abdominal pain: ____/5 Notes: _____
Constipation: ____/5 Notes: _____
Diarrhea: ____/5 Notes: _____
Acid reflux: ____/5 Notes: _____
Nausea: ____/5 Notes: _____
Fatigue: ____/5 Notes: _____
Brain fog: ____/5 Notes: _____
Headaches: ____/5 Notes: _____
Joint pain: ____/5 Notes: _____
Skin issues: ____/5 Notes: _____
Mood changes: ____/5 Notes: _____
Sugar cravings: ____/5 Notes: _____
Food reactions: ____/5 Notes: _____

Total Score: ____/75

Score Interpretation

- 0-15: Mild gut issues - focus on optimization
- 16-35: Moderate dysfunction - elimination diet recommended
- 36-55: Significant issues - consider professional guidance
- 56-75: Severe - work with a functional medicine practitioner

Bristol Stool Chart Reference

Track your stool type daily using this scale:

- Type 1: Separate hard lumps (severe constipation)
- Type 2: Lumpy, sausage-shaped (mild constipation)
- Type 3: Sausage with cracks (normal)
- Type 4: Smooth, soft sausage (ideal)
- Type 5: Soft blobs with clear edges (lacking fiber)
- Type 6: Mushy, fluffy pieces (mild diarrhea)
- Type 7: Watery, no solid pieces (severe diarrhea)

Chapter 3: The Elimination Diet Protocol

Phase 1: Elimination (2-4 Weeks)

Remove common trigger foods completely for 2-4 weeks until symptoms improve.

Foods to REMOVE

- Gluten (wheat, barley, rye, spelt)
- Dairy (milk, cheese, yogurt, butter)
- Eggs
- Soy (tofu, soy sauce, edamame)
- Corn
- Refined sugar and artificial sweeteners
- Alcohol
- Caffeine (or reduce to 1 cup green tea)
- Processed and packaged foods

Foods to EAT Freely

- All vegetables (especially leafy greens)
- Most fruits (limit high-sugar tropical fruits)
- Lean proteins: chicken, turkey, fish
- Healthy fats: olive oil, avocado, coconut oil
- Gluten-free grains: rice, quinoa, millet
- Nuts and seeds (if tolerated)
- Herbs, spices, and bone broth

Phase 2: Reintroduction (6-8 Weeks)

Reintroduce one food at a time, every 3-4 days, and monitor reactions.

Reintroduction Protocol

- Day 1: Eat the test food 2-3 times
- Days 2-3: Remove the food and monitor symptoms
- Day 4: If no reaction, move to next food
- If reaction occurs: Remove food, wait until symptoms clear, then test next food

Reintroduction Order (least to most reactive)

- 1. Eggs
- 2. Dairy (start with butter/ghee)
- 3. Gluten-free grains (oats)
- 4. Soy
- 5. Corn
- 6. Gluten (start with sourdough)

Chapter 4: Food Sensitivity Tracker

Use these pages to track your elimination and reintroduction phases.

Daily Gut Health Tracker - Page 1

Day: _____ Date: __/__/____
Breakfast: _____
Lunch: _____
Dinner: _____
Snacks: _____
Bloating (1-10): _____
Pain (1-10): _____
Stool Type (1-7): _____
Energy (1-10): _____
Mood (1-10): _____
Reactions/Notes: _____

Day: _____ Date: __/__/____
Breakfast: _____
Lunch: _____
Dinner: _____
Snacks: _____
Bloating (1-10): _____
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Energy (1-10): _____
Mood (1-10): _____
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Breakfast: _____
Lunch: _____
Dinner: _____
Snacks: _____
Bloating (1-10): _____
Pain (1-10): _____
Stool Type (1-7): _____
Energy (1-10): _____
Mood (1-10): _____
Reactions/Notes: _____

Daily Gut Health Tracker - Page 2

Day: _____ Date: __/__/____

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

Snacks: _____

Bloating (1-10): _____

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Stool Type (1-7): _____

Energy (1-10): _____

Mood (1-10): _____

Reactions/Notes: _____

Day: _____ Date: __/__/____

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

Snacks: _____

Bloating (1-10): _____

Pain (1-10): _____

Stool Type (1-7): _____

Energy (1-10): _____

Mood (1-10): _____

Reactions/Notes: _____

Day: _____ Date: __/__/____

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

Snacks: _____

Bloating (1-10): _____

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Mood (1-10): _____

Reactions/Notes: _____

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Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

Snacks: _____

Bloating (1-10): _____
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Stool Type (1-7): _____
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Mood (1-10): _____
Reactions/Notes: _____

Day: _____ Date: __/__/__

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

Snacks: _____

Bloating (1-10): _____

Pain (1-10): _____

Stool Type (1-7): _____

Energy (1-10): _____

Mood (1-10): _____

Reactions/Notes: _____

Daily Gut Health Tracker - Page 3

Day: _____ Date: __/__/____

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

Snacks: _____

Bloating (1-10): _____

Pain (1-10): _____

Stool Type (1-7): _____

Energy (1-10): _____

Mood (1-10): _____

Reactions/Notes: _____

Day: _____ Date: __/__/____

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

Snacks: _____

Bloating (1-10): _____

Pain (1-10): _____

Stool Type (1-7): _____

Energy (1-10): _____

Mood (1-10): _____

Reactions/Notes: _____

Day: _____ Date: __/__/____

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

Snacks: _____

Bloating (1-10): _____

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Stool Type (1-7): _____

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Day: _____ Date: __/__/____

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Lunch: _____

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Snacks: _____

Bloating (1-10): _____
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Snacks: _____

Bloating (1-10): _____

Pain (1-10): _____

Stool Type (1-7): _____

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Reactions/Notes: _____

Daily Gut Health Tracker - Page 4

Day: _____ Date: __/__/__

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

Snacks: _____

Bloating (1-10): _____

Pain (1-10): _____

Stool Type (1-7): _____

Energy (1-10): _____

Mood (1-10): _____

Reactions/Notes: _____

Day: _____ Date: __/__/__

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

Snacks: _____

Bloating (1-10): _____

Pain (1-10): _____

Stool Type (1-7): _____

Energy (1-10): _____

Mood (1-10): _____

Reactions/Notes: _____

Day: _____ Date: __/__/__

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

Snacks: _____

Bloating (1-10): _____

Pain (1-10): _____

Stool Type (1-7): _____

Energy (1-10): _____

Mood (1-10): _____

Reactions/Notes: _____

Day: _____ Date: __/__/__

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

Snacks: _____

Bloating (1-10): _____
Pain (1-10): _____
Stool Type (1-7): _____
Energy (1-10): _____
Mood (1-10): _____
Reactions/Notes: _____

Day: _____ Date: __/__/__

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

Snacks: _____

Bloating (1-10): _____

Pain (1-10): _____

Stool Type (1-7): _____

Energy (1-10): _____

Mood (1-10): _____

Reactions/Notes: _____

Daily Gut Health Tracker - Page 5

Day: _____ Date: __/__/____

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

Snacks: _____

Bloating (1-10): _____

Pain (1-10): _____

Stool Type (1-7): _____

Energy (1-10): _____

Mood (1-10): _____

Reactions/Notes: _____

Day: _____ Date: __/__/____

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

Snacks: _____

Bloating (1-10): _____

Pain (1-10): _____

Stool Type (1-7): _____

Energy (1-10): _____

Mood (1-10): _____

Reactions/Notes: _____

Day: _____ Date: __/__/____

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

Snacks: _____

Bloating (1-10): _____

Pain (1-10): _____

Stool Type (1-7): _____

Energy (1-10): _____

Mood (1-10): _____

Reactions/Notes: _____

Day: _____ Date: __/__/____

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

Snacks: _____

Bloating (1-10): _____
Pain (1-10): _____
Stool Type (1-7): _____
Energy (1-10): _____
Mood (1-10): _____
Reactions/Notes: _____

Day: _____ Date: __/__/__

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

Snacks: _____

Bloating (1-10): _____

Pain (1-10): _____

Stool Type (1-7): _____

Energy (1-10): _____

Mood (1-10): _____

Reactions/Notes: _____

Daily Gut Health Tracker - Page 6

Day: _____ Date: __/__/__

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

Snacks: _____

Bloating (1-10): _____

Pain (1-10): _____

Stool Type (1-7): _____

Energy (1-10): _____

Mood (1-10): _____

Reactions/Notes: _____

Day: _____ Date: __/__/__

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

Snacks: _____

Bloating (1-10): _____

Pain (1-10): _____

Stool Type (1-7): _____

Energy (1-10): _____

Mood (1-10): _____

Reactions/Notes: _____

Day: _____ Date: __/__/__

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

Snacks: _____

Bloating (1-10): _____

Pain (1-10): _____

Stool Type (1-7): _____

Energy (1-10): _____

Mood (1-10): _____

Reactions/Notes: _____

Day: _____ Date: __/__/__

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

Snacks: _____

Bloating (1-10): _____
Pain (1-10): _____
Stool Type (1-7): _____
Energy (1-10): _____
Mood (1-10): _____
Reactions/Notes: _____

Day: _____ Date: __/__/__

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

Snacks: _____

Bloating (1-10): _____

Pain (1-10): _____

Stool Type (1-7): _____

Energy (1-10): _____

Mood (1-10): _____

Reactions/Notes: _____

Daily Gut Health Tracker - Page 7

Day: _____ Date: __/__/__

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

Snacks: _____

Bloating (1-10): _____

Pain (1-10): _____

Stool Type (1-7): _____

Energy (1-10): _____

Mood (1-10): _____

Reactions/Notes: _____

Day: _____ Date: __/__/__

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

Snacks: _____

Bloating (1-10): _____

Pain (1-10): _____

Stool Type (1-7): _____

Energy (1-10): _____

Mood (1-10): _____

Reactions/Notes: _____

Day: _____ Date: __/__/__

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

Snacks: _____

Bloating (1-10): _____

Pain (1-10): _____

Stool Type (1-7): _____

Energy (1-10): _____

Mood (1-10): _____

Reactions/Notes: _____

Day: _____ Date: __/__/__

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

Snacks: _____

Bloating (1-10): _____
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Stool Type (1-7): _____
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Mood (1-10): _____
Reactions/Notes: _____

Day: _____ Date: __/__/__

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

Snacks: _____

Bloating (1-10): _____

Pain (1-10): _____

Stool Type (1-7): _____

Energy (1-10): _____

Mood (1-10): _____

Reactions/Notes: _____

Daily Gut Health Tracker - Page 8

Day: _____ Date: __/__/__

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

Snacks: _____

Bloating (1-10): _____

Pain (1-10): _____

Stool Type (1-7): _____

Energy (1-10): _____

Mood (1-10): _____

Reactions/Notes: _____

Day: _____ Date: __/__/__

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

Snacks: _____

Bloating (1-10): _____

Pain (1-10): _____

Stool Type (1-7): _____

Energy (1-10): _____

Mood (1-10): _____

Reactions/Notes: _____

Day: _____ Date: __/__/__

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

Snacks: _____

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Dinner: _____

Snacks: _____

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Dinner: _____

Snacks: _____

Bloating (1-10): _____

Pain (1-10): _____

Stool Type (1-7): _____

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Reactions/Notes: _____

Daily Gut Health Tracker - Page 9

Day: _____ Date: __/__/____

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

Snacks: _____

Bloating (1-10): _____

Pain (1-10): _____

Stool Type (1-7): _____

Energy (1-10): _____

Mood (1-10): _____

Reactions/Notes: _____

Day: _____ Date: __/__/____

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

Snacks: _____

Bloating (1-10): _____

Pain (1-10): _____

Stool Type (1-7): _____

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Mood (1-10): _____

Reactions/Notes: _____

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Breakfast: _____

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Dinner: _____

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Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

Snacks: _____

Bloating (1-10): _____

Pain (1-10): _____

Stool Type (1-7): _____

Energy (1-10): _____

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Reactions/Notes: _____

Daily Gut Health Tracker - Page 10

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Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

Snacks: _____

Bloating (1-10): _____

Pain (1-10): _____

Stool Type (1-7): _____

Energy (1-10): _____

Mood (1-10): _____

Reactions/Notes: _____

Day: _____ Date: __/__/__

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

Snacks: _____

Bloating (1-10): _____

Pain (1-10): _____

Stool Type (1-7): _____

Energy (1-10): _____

Mood (1-10): _____

Reactions/Notes: _____

Day: _____ Date: __/__/__

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

Snacks: _____

Bloating (1-10): _____

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Stool Type (1-7): _____

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Snacks: _____

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Snacks: _____

Bloating (1-10): _____

Pain (1-10): _____

Stool Type (1-7): _____

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Reactions/Notes: _____

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Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

Snacks: _____

Bloating (1-10): _____

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Stool Type (1-7): _____

Energy (1-10): _____

Mood (1-10): _____

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Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

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Snacks: _____

Bloating (1-10): _____

Pain (1-10): _____

Stool Type (1-7): _____

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Reactions/Notes: _____

Daily Gut Health Tracker - Page 12

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Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

Snacks: _____

Bloating (1-10): _____

Pain (1-10): _____

Stool Type (1-7): _____

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Mood (1-10): _____

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Lunch: _____

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Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

Snacks: _____

Bloating (1-10): _____
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Stool Type (1-7): _____
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Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

Snacks: _____

Bloating (1-10): _____

Pain (1-10): _____

Stool Type (1-7): _____

Energy (1-10): _____

Mood (1-10): _____

Reactions/Notes: _____

Daily Gut Health Tracker - Page 13

Day: _____ Date: __/__/__

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

Snacks: _____

Bloating (1-10): _____

Pain (1-10): _____

Stool Type (1-7): _____

Energy (1-10): _____

Mood (1-10): _____

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Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

Snacks: _____

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Stool Type (1-7): _____

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Reactions/Notes: _____

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Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

Snacks: _____

Bloating (1-10): _____

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Stool Type (1-7): _____

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Mood (1-10): _____

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Day: _____ Date: __/__/__

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

Snacks: _____

Bloating (1-10): _____
Pain (1-10): _____
Stool Type (1-7): _____
Energy (1-10): _____
Mood (1-10): _____
Reactions/Notes: _____

Day: _____ Date: __/__/__

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

Snacks: _____

Bloating (1-10): _____

Pain (1-10): _____

Stool Type (1-7): _____

Energy (1-10): _____

Mood (1-10): _____

Reactions/Notes: _____

Daily Gut Health Tracker - Page 14

Day: _____ Date: __/__/__

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

Snacks: _____

Bloating (1-10): _____

Pain (1-10): _____

Stool Type (1-7): _____

Energy (1-10): _____

Mood (1-10): _____

Reactions/Notes: _____

Day: _____ Date: __/__/__

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

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Pain (1-10): _____

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Energy (1-10): _____

Mood (1-10): _____

Reactions/Notes: _____

Day: _____ Date: __/__/__

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

Snacks: _____

Bloating (1-10): _____
Pain (1-10): _____
Stool Type (1-7): _____
Energy (1-10): _____
Mood (1-10): _____
Reactions/Notes: _____

Day: _____ Date: __/__/__

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

Snacks: _____

Bloating (1-10): _____

Pain (1-10): _____

Stool Type (1-7): _____

Energy (1-10): _____

Mood (1-10): _____

Reactions/Notes: _____

Daily Gut Health Tracker - Page 15

Day: _____ Date: __/__/__

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

Snacks: _____

Bloating (1-10): _____

Pain (1-10): _____

Stool Type (1-7): _____

Energy (1-10): _____

Mood (1-10): _____

Reactions/Notes: _____

Day: _____ Date: __/__/__

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

Snacks: _____

Bloating (1-10): _____

Pain (1-10): _____

Stool Type (1-7): _____

Energy (1-10): _____

Mood (1-10): _____

Reactions/Notes: _____

Day: _____ Date: __/__/__

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

Snacks: _____

Bloating (1-10): _____

Pain (1-10): _____

Stool Type (1-7): _____

Energy (1-10): _____

Mood (1-10): _____

Reactions/Notes: _____

Day: _____ Date: __/__/__

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

Snacks: _____

Bloating (1-10): _____
Pain (1-10): _____
Stool Type (1-7): _____
Energy (1-10): _____
Mood (1-10): _____
Reactions/Notes: _____

Day: _____ Date: __/__/__

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

Snacks: _____

Bloating (1-10): _____

Pain (1-10): _____

Stool Type (1-7): _____

Energy (1-10): _____

Mood (1-10): _____

Reactions/Notes: _____

Daily Gut Health Tracker - Page 16

Day: _____ Date: __/__/__

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

Snacks: _____

Bloating (1-10): _____

Pain (1-10): _____

Stool Type (1-7): _____

Energy (1-10): _____

Mood (1-10): _____

Reactions/Notes: _____

Day: _____ Date: __/__/__

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

Snacks: _____

Bloating (1-10): _____

Pain (1-10): _____

Stool Type (1-7): _____

Energy (1-10): _____

Mood (1-10): _____

Reactions/Notes: _____

Day: _____ Date: __/__/__

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

Snacks: _____

Bloating (1-10): _____

Pain (1-10): _____

Stool Type (1-7): _____

Energy (1-10): _____

Mood (1-10): _____

Reactions/Notes: _____

Day: _____ Date: __/__/__

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

Snacks: _____

Bloating (1-10): _____
Pain (1-10): _____
Stool Type (1-7): _____
Energy (1-10): _____
Mood (1-10): _____
Reactions/Notes: _____

Day: _____ Date: __/__/__

Breakfast: _____

Lunch: _____

Dinner: _____

Snacks: _____

Bloating (1-10): _____

Pain (1-10): _____

Stool Type (1-7): _____

Energy (1-10): _____

Mood (1-10): _____

Reactions/Notes: _____

Chapter 5: Gut-Healing Nutrition Plan

Gut-Healing Foods

Prebiotic Foods (feed good bacteria)

- Garlic, onions, leeks
- Asparagus, artichokes
- Bananas (slightly green)
- Oats and flaxseeds
- Apples (with skin)

Probiotic Foods (add good bacteria)

- Sauerkraut (unpasteurized)
- Kimchi
- Kombucha
- Coconut yogurt
- Miso and tempeh

Gut-Lining Repair Foods

- Bone broth (collagen and amino acids)
- Cabbage juice (L-glutamine)
- Slippery elm and marshmallow root tea
- Aloe vera juice
- Zinc-rich foods (pumpkin seeds, oysters)

7-Day Gut Healing Meal Plan

Monday

- Breakfast: Bone broth + scrambled eggs with spinach
- Lunch: Chicken and vegetable soup
- Dinner: Baked salmon with steamed vegetables

Tuesday

- Breakfast: Smoothie: banana, coconut yogurt, flax
- Lunch: Turkey lettuce wraps with avocado
- Dinner: Slow-cooker chicken with root vegetables

Wednesday

- Breakfast: Overnight oats with berries and seeds
- Lunch: Bone broth soup with greens
- Dinner: Grilled fish with quinoa and asparagus

Thursday

- Breakfast: Scrambled eggs with sauerkraut
- Lunch: Large salad with olive oil dressing
- Dinner: Chicken stir-fry with coconut aminos

Friday

- Breakfast: Coconut yogurt parfait with seeds
- Lunch: Lentil soup (if tolerated)
- Dinner: Baked cod with sweet potato

Saturday

- Breakfast: Sweet potato hash with eggs
- Lunch: Leftover fish and veggie bowl
- Dinner: Turkey meatballs with zucchini noodles

Sunday

- Breakfast: Green smoothie with collagen powder
- Lunch: Bone broth with vegetables
- Dinner: Roast chicken with roasted vegetables

Chapter 6: Lifestyle Strategies for Gut Health

Stress and Your Gut

The gut-brain axis means stress directly impacts digestion. Chronic stress reduces beneficial bacteria, increases gut permeability, and slows motility.

- Practice diaphragmatic breathing before meals
- Eat in a calm, relaxed environment
- Chew food thoroughly (30+ chews per bite)
- Avoid eating while stressed or distracted
- Daily meditation or yoga

Sleep and Gut Health

Poor sleep disrupts the circadian rhythms of your gut bacteria.

- Consistent sleep schedule supports microbiome diversity
- Avoid large meals within 3 hours of bedtime
- Aim for 7-9 hours of quality sleep

Movement for Digestion

- Gentle walking after meals aids digestion
- Yoga poses for digestion (twists, forward folds)
- Regular exercise increases microbiome diversity
- Avoid intense exercise immediately after eating

Chapter 7: Progress Review & Reintroduction Log

Food Reintroduction Record

Reintroduction Test #1

Food Being Tested: _____
Date Started: __/__/____
Amount Consumed: _____
Symptoms (0-24 hours): _____
Symptoms (24-72 hours): _____
Result: ☐ PASS (no reaction) ☐ FAIL (reaction)
Notes: _____

Reintroduction Test #2

Food Being Tested: _____
Date Started: __/__/____
Amount Consumed: _____
Symptoms (0-24 hours): _____
Symptoms (24-72 hours): _____
Result: ☐ PASS (no reaction) ☐ FAIL (reaction)
Notes: _____

Reintroduction Test #3

Food Being Tested: _____
Date Started: __/__/____
Amount Consumed: _____
Symptoms (0-24 hours): _____
Symptoms (24-72 hours): _____
Result: ☐ PASS (no reaction) ☐ FAIL (reaction)
Notes: _____

Reintroduction Test #4

Food Being Tested: _____
Date Started: __/__/____
Amount Consumed: _____
Symptoms (0-24 hours): _____
Symptoms (24-72 hours): _____
Result: ☐ PASS (no reaction) ☐ FAIL (reaction)
Notes: _____

Reintroduction Test #5

Food Being Tested: _____
Date Started: __/__/____
Amount Consumed: _____
Symptoms (0-24 hours): _____
Symptoms (24-72 hours): _____
Result: ☐ PASS (no reaction) ☐ FAIL (reaction)
Notes: _____

Reintroduction Test #6

Food Being Tested: _____
Date Started: __/__/____
Amount Consumed: _____
Symptoms (0-24 hours): _____
Symptoms (24-72 hours): _____
Result: ☐ PASS (no reaction) ☐ FAIL (reaction)
Notes: _____

Reintroduction Test #7

Food Being Tested: _____
Date Started: __/__/____
Amount Consumed: _____
Symptoms (0-24 hours): _____
Symptoms (24-72 hours): _____
Result: ☐ PASS (no reaction) ☐ FAIL (reaction)
Notes: _____

Reintroduction Test #8

Food Being Tested: _____
Date Started: __/__/____
Amount Consumed: _____
Symptoms (0-24 hours): _____
Symptoms (24-72 hours): _____
Result: ☐ PASS (no reaction) ☐ FAIL (reaction)
Notes: _____

Week 1 Review

Date Range: __/__/____ to __/__/____

Overall digestion this week (1-10):

Bloating frequency (times per week):

Energy level average:

Foods that worked well:

Foods that caused issues:

Stool consistency pattern:

Supplement changes:

Goals for next week:

Week 2 Review

Date Range: __/__/____ to __/__/____

Overall digestion this week (1-10):

Bloating frequency (times per week):

Energy level average:

Foods that worked well:

Foods that caused issues:

Stool consistency pattern:

Supplement changes:

Goals for next week:

Week 3 Review

Date Range: __/__/____ to __/__/____

Overall digestion this week (1-10):

Bloating frequency (times per week):

Energy level average:

Foods that worked well:

Foods that caused issues:

Stool consistency pattern:

Supplement changes:

Goals for next week:

Week 4 Review

Date Range: __/__/____ to __/__/____

Overall digestion this week (1-10):

Bloating frequency (times per week):

Energy level average:

Foods that worked well:

Foods that caused issues:

Stool consistency pattern:

Supplement changes:

Goals for next week:

Frequently Asked Questions

Q: How long does gut healing take?

It varies by individual. Most people see improvement in 2-4 weeks, but full healing of gut lining can take 3-6 months. Consistency is key.

Q: Do I need a probiotic supplement?

Food-based probiotics are preferred. If supplementing, choose a multi-strain probiotic with at least 10 billion CFUs. Start slowly to avoid die-off symptoms.

Q: What is leaky gut?

Intestinal permeability ('leaky gut') occurs when tight junctions in the gut lining weaken, allowing particles to enter the bloodstream and trigger immune reactions.

Q: Can stress really affect my gut?

Absolutely. The gut-brain axis is a bidirectional communication system. Stress can change gut motility, increase permeability, and alter the microbiome within hours.

Q: Should I get tested for food sensitivities?

Testing can be helpful but is not always accurate. The gold standard remains an elimination diet with careful reintroduction and symptom tracking.

Q: How do I know if I need medical help?

See a doctor if you have blood in stool, unexplained weight loss, severe pain, fever, or symptoms that don't improve after 4-6 weeks of dietary changes.

Q: Is bone broth really beneficial?

Yes. Bone broth contains collagen, glutamine, glycine, and gelatin - all of which support gut lining repair and reduce inflammation.

Q: Can I heal my gut while on medications?

Yes, though some medications (PPIs, NSAIDs, antibiotics) can slow healing. Never stop medications without medical guidance.

Q: What about FODMAPs?

If you have IBS, a low-FODMAP diet may help identify specific carbohydrate triggers. Consider working with a registered dietitian for this protocol.

Q: How do I rebuild my microbiome after antibiotics?

Focus on diverse fiber intake, fermented foods, and possibly a probiotic supplement for 2-3 months. Eat 30+ different plant foods per week.

Resources

Quick-Reference: Daily Gut Health Checklist

- ☐ Ate prebiotic-rich foods (garlic, onions, asparagus)
- ☐ Consumed probiotic food (sauerkraut, kimchi, yogurt)
- ☐ Drank bone broth or gut-healing tea
- ☐ Chewed food thoroughly and ate mindfully
- ☐ Managed stress (breathing, meditation)
- ☐ Drank adequate water between meals
- ☐ Avoided known trigger foods
- ☐ Gentle movement or walking after meals

Notes & Reflections

Use these pages to record your thoughts, observations, and insights as you work through this workbook.

Notes - Page 1

Date: ____/____/____

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Notes - Page 2

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Notes - Page 4

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Notes - Page 5

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Notes - Page 13

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Notes - Page 14

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Notes - Page 15

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Notes - Page 16

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Notes - Page 19

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About the Author

Daniel Tesfamariam is a health and wellness content creator dedicated to making evidence-based health information accessible and actionable. Through carefully designed workbooks and guides, Daniel helps people take control of their health journey with practical tools, trackers, and strategies.

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Thank you for investing in your health. You deserve to feel your best.